

PAGE LAYOUT SOFTWARE

Since the print publishing industry was amongst the early adopters of computers, page layout software tends to be higher on the evolution curve than other software. This is obvious from the fact that the new versions released this year had only some small refinements such as the inclusion of better image editing capabilities, filter effects and support for the Web. The improved integration with other technologies, especially the Internet, has led to the increasing use of page layout software to create hard-hitting and visually creative content, which can be directly used on the Web.

Adobe has already announced the launch of InDesign 2.0, which supports object transparency, long-document management options, one-step table creation and XML support. QuarkXPress 5, still in its beta stages, also promises to incorporate better importing capabilities and it also extends support for XML. Obviously, support for XML, which promises to become a standardised mode for the exchange of documents and data, is an important direction for the future.



Adobe InDesign 1.5.2



A slick and intuitive interface makes it simpler to use and several new features give it an added edge

Adobe InDesign won the war purely because of the improvements in functionality with the inclusion of tools such as the pen tool, eye-dropper, frame, selection, and drawing tools. It is now equipped with better import filters and also offers you a choice of multi-line or single-line composers, vertical text justification, extensive kerning options, and the ability to align text to any path and then manipulate it to create eye-catching effects.

+ Aesthetic interface and intuitive page layout capabilities
+ Good importing capabilities
Price: Rs 42,946
Contact: Adobe Systems (I) Pvt Ltd

Phone: 0118-4532026
Fax: 0118-4532010
E-mail: sandeepm@adobe.com
Web site: www.adobe.com
Reviewed in: November 2001

Worthy Mentions

QuarkXPress 4.1

+ Simple interface
+ Very light on system resources
Price: Rs 34,000
Contact: Quark India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 0172-254412
Fax: 0172-254414
E-mail: gprakash@quarkindia.com
Web site: www.quarkindia.com
Reviewed in: November 2001

Adobe PageMaker 7

+ Support for scripts and plugins
+ Good image editing capabilities
Price: Rs 26,500
Contact: Adobe Systems India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 0118-4532026
Fax: 0118-4532010
E-mail: sandeepm@adobe.com
Web site: www.adobe.com
Reviewed in: November 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Corel Ventura 8.0 1999: Corel Ventura 8.0 1998: Adobe PageMaker 6.5

PERSONAL INFORMATION MANAGERS

While managing time might have been low on the priority list of most people a while ago, it is of increasing importance in our hectic and always connected lives today. Gone are the days when one had to rely on one's own memory to store personal information about acquaintances. Personal Information Managers (PIMs) have become indispensable as they allow scheduling of important tasks in addition to storing all kinds of information that hitherto existed in the confines of personal diaries. PIMs now integrate with other applications and let you dial a phone number, send a fax or e-mail and more. This means that many of the mundane tasks are taken off the users hands.

Time management is critical given that most professionals today lead a highly connected life. However, collaboration will quickly become the key component that brings together the collage of applications that makes up a PIM. Old favourites such

as Lotus Organiser need to move towards facilitating closer interaction between applications and people if they are to remain popular.



Microsoft Outlook 2002



Tight integration between PIM, the e-mail client and other Office applications make this an ideal choice

The latest version of this PIM from Microsoft, which comes bundled with its Office XP suite, has excellent integration with the OS and other Office applications. Along with mail options, it also allows one to dial to mobile phones and land lines. The Address book has a neat way of sorting the contacts alphabetically. The package also includes features such as small notes and stickies, which cling onto Outlook but can also be moved to other applications and to the Windows Desktop.

+ Outstanding e-mail client; excellent collaboration tools
+ Extremely user friendly and functional
+ Nice integration with MS Office applications

Price: Rs 5,000
Contact: Microsoft Corporation India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 011-6294600
Fax: 011-6292650
E-mail: msconnect@microsoft.com

Worthy Mentions

Redbox 4.0

+ Some really interesting features such as colour templates and images in the address book
+ Ability to link various items from different fields
+ Wizards for Web publishing
Price: Rs 458
Contact: www.inklineglobal.net
Reviewed in: July 2001

Lotus Organizer 6

+ Visually appealing and feature packed
Price: Rs 3,680
Contact: Tech Pacific
Phone: 022-5960101
Fax: 022-5960304
E-mail: adil@techpacificindia.com
Reviewed in: July 2001

PREVIOUS WINNERS 2000: Microsoft Outlook 2000 1999: Lotus Organizer 4.5 1998: Lotus Organizer 4.01

